Vopak

South Africa liquid fuels market story

Inland supply, corridor capture and tank turnover

Durban–Lesedi corridor into Gauteng

11 October 2026

Public evidence and illustrative capture cases. Customer access, operating limits and returns remain provisional.

Photo source: Royal Vopak | Terminal Durban | vopak.com



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South Africa remains an import-led fuel market, making customer capture Vopak's priority

SITUATION

A large fuel market relies on substantial imports

2025 demand is estimated at 21.0bn litres: 8.9bn petrol and 12.1bn diesel, down from 21.9bn litres in 2023. Road use dominates, alongside mining, agriculture and power. With domestic production assumed at 5.8bn litres, gross import need is about 16.7bn litres.

COMPLICATION

Sector growth supports demand, but five drivers reshape fuel flows through Durban

Mining, manufacturing and agriculture	Production, exports and harvests drive equipment and freight demand; different sector growth paths produce different fuel-demand outcomes.
Eskom and power generation	Eskom recovery reduces peaking and backup diesel at utilities, mines, factories and farms, while better electricity supply can support higher activity.
Road-to-rail shift and vehicle efficiency	Moving mining, agricultural and manufactured goods from trucks to rail reduces road diesel use; vehicle efficiency further lowers fuel per unit of activity.
Refineries and domestic fuel production	Higher operating output or refinery restarts could displace imports relative to the 5.8bn-litre production assumption; lower output increases import need.
Matola and Walvis Bay	Alternative gateways could divert inland supply from Durban, depending on delivered cost, reliability and customer access.

RESOLUTION

Vopak should secure customer capture before expanding capacity

Base-case imports remain about 16.6bn litres in 2030. Illustrative capture is 2.63bn litres through Durban, including 1.32bn onward through Lesedi within the same flow; this fits the preliminary working-tank screen.

Expansion requires secured incremental volumes and a demonstrated capacity shortfall.

Source: analytical workbook v02 and market review. Demand is estimated; production and capture are planning assumptions. Product reconciliation remains open; Walvis Bay diversion is unquantified.

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Our 2025 baseline is 21.0bn litres, with road use accounting for most demand

Demand segment	2025 estimate bn litres	Change since 2023 bn litres
Petrol road use	8.59	-0.18
Mining	1.41	0.01
Manufacturing	0.17	-0.00
Agriculture	1.13	0.08
Utility and private power	1.08	-0.99
Road freight diesel	4.82	-0.02
Other road diesel	1.61	-0.01
Other petrol	0.27	-0.01
Other diesel / unallocated	1.91	0.16

Petrol: 8.86bn L. Diesel: 12.13bn L. Total demand falls from 21.94bn L in 2023 to an estimated 20.99bn L in 2025.

Department sales through 2023; energy balances and Stats SA activity; Eskom/IPP evidence. All 2025 segment allocations are estimates; other diesel retains an explicit residual.

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Demand stays broadly flat in our base case; supply and routes determine where imports enter

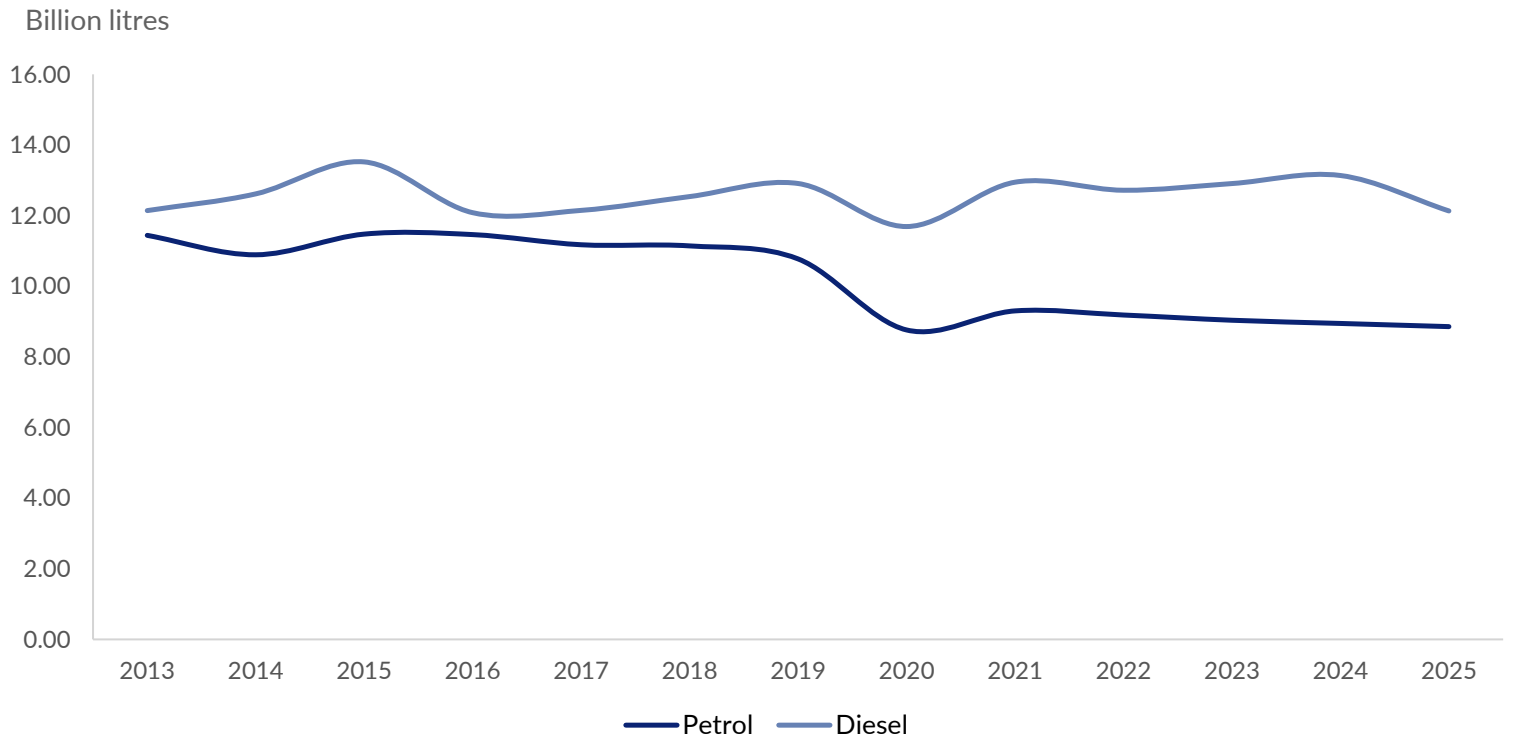
Driver and deep dive	Evidence / planning assumption	Base-case implication by 2030
Power | pp9–10	Eskom fuel fell from 1.13bn L in FY2024 to 0.68bn in FY2025	Power demand reduction: 0.54bn L; includes assumed private backup
Freight and vehicles | pp8, 11–12	7.5% road-freight shift to rail; 1% annual road-fuel efficiency gain	Rail saves 0.33bn L; road efficiency saves 0.79bn L
Domestic production | pp13–15	5.8bn L directed planning baseline; no restart in base case	Demand-implied gross imports remain about 16.6bn L in 2030
Mozambique routes | pp16–17	Existing Matola infrastructure and an assumed 0.20bn L additional SA flow	Imports change gateway; national fuel demand stays unchanged

Activity adds 1.54bn L by 2030, broadly offsetting power, efficiency and rail reductions. Customer access determines Vopak capture.

2025 analytical workbook v02: registered demand assumptions and user-directed 5.8bn L domestic production case. Estimates are not reported actuals.

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Petrol has declined since 2013, while diesel has sustained the market



2025 estimate

Petrol 8.86bn litres

Diesel 12.13bn litres

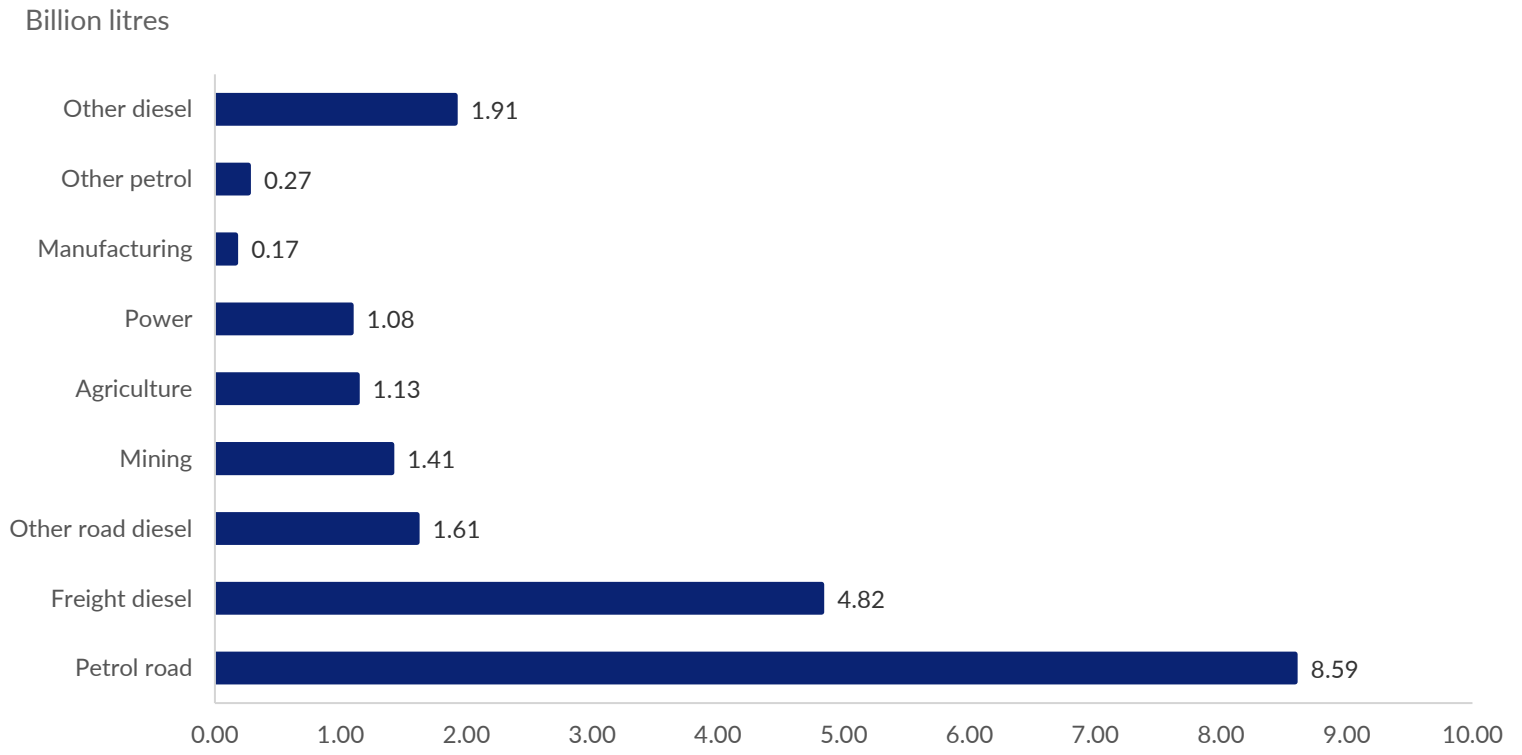
2024–25 are estimates; 2013–23 use one consistent Department series.

Petrol remains below its earlier level; diesel demand responds more directly to freight, industry and power.

Department annual sales, 2013–2023. Estimated 2024–2025: analytical workbook v02. Earlier deck FIASA comparison figures are not spliced into this series.

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Road use dominates the baseline, with meaningful diesel demand outside transport



Demand allocation

Road freight: 4.82bn L

Mining: 1.41bn L

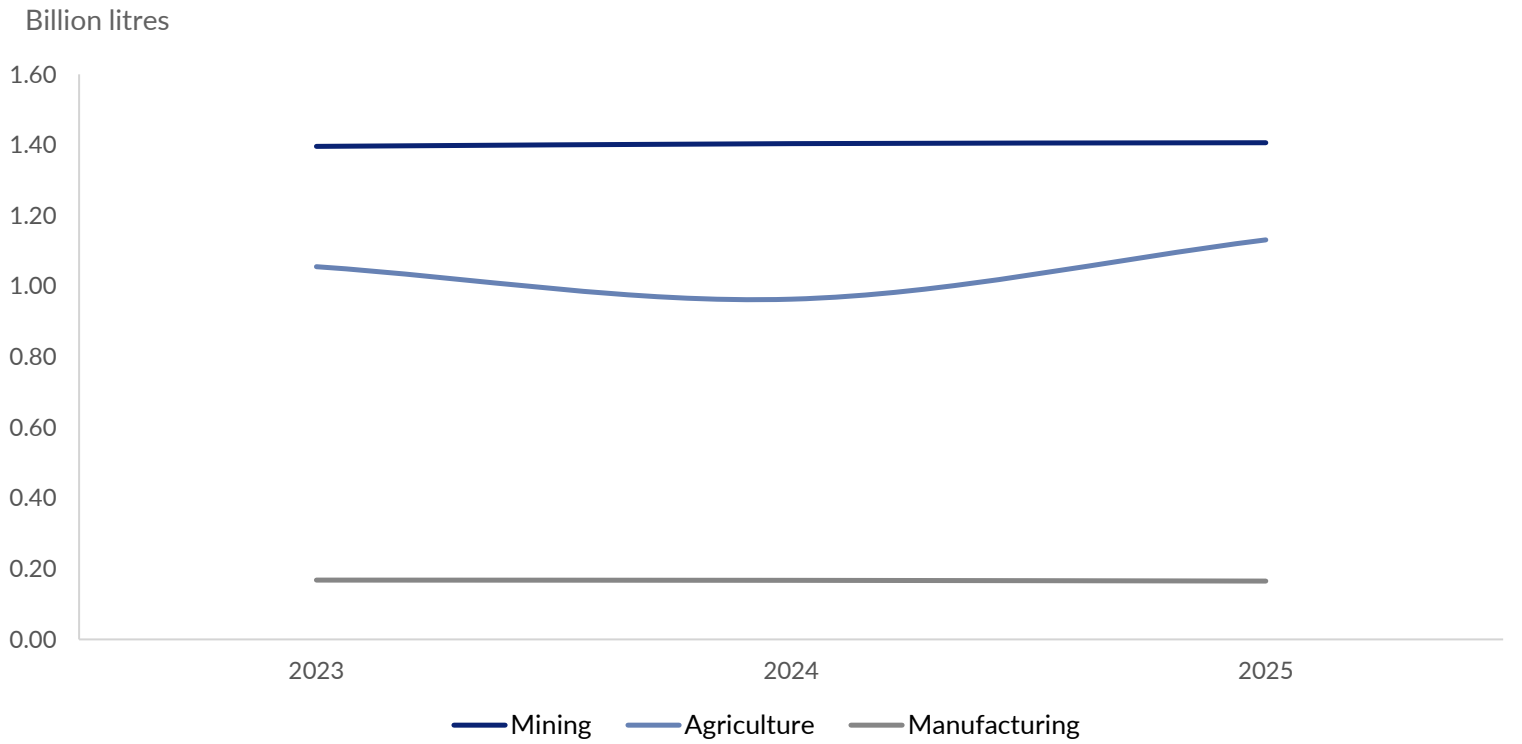
Agriculture: 1.13bn L

Other diesel: 1.91bn L remains unallocated to a specific end use.

Sector-attributed vehicle fuel stays in its sector; the road split is an explicit allocation assumption.

Analytical workbook v02, Segments. 2021 energy-balance road volume; 75% of road diesel allocated to freight. Historical sector intensities at current activity.

Agricultural demand rebounds in 2025 while mining and manufacturing remain broadly flat



Estimated diesel use

Mining: 1.40 → 1.41bn L

Agriculture: 1.06 → 1.13bn L

Manufacturing: about 0.17bn L

Manufacturing covers the energy-balance industry residual, not a complete industrial census.

Sector activity produces different demand paths; applying one GDP growth rate would hide these differences.

Stats SA mining/manufacturing indices and agriculture real GVA; mean 2018–2021 fuel intensity. Sector diesel values after 2021 are estimates.

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Efficiency offsets activity growth in the petrol baseline

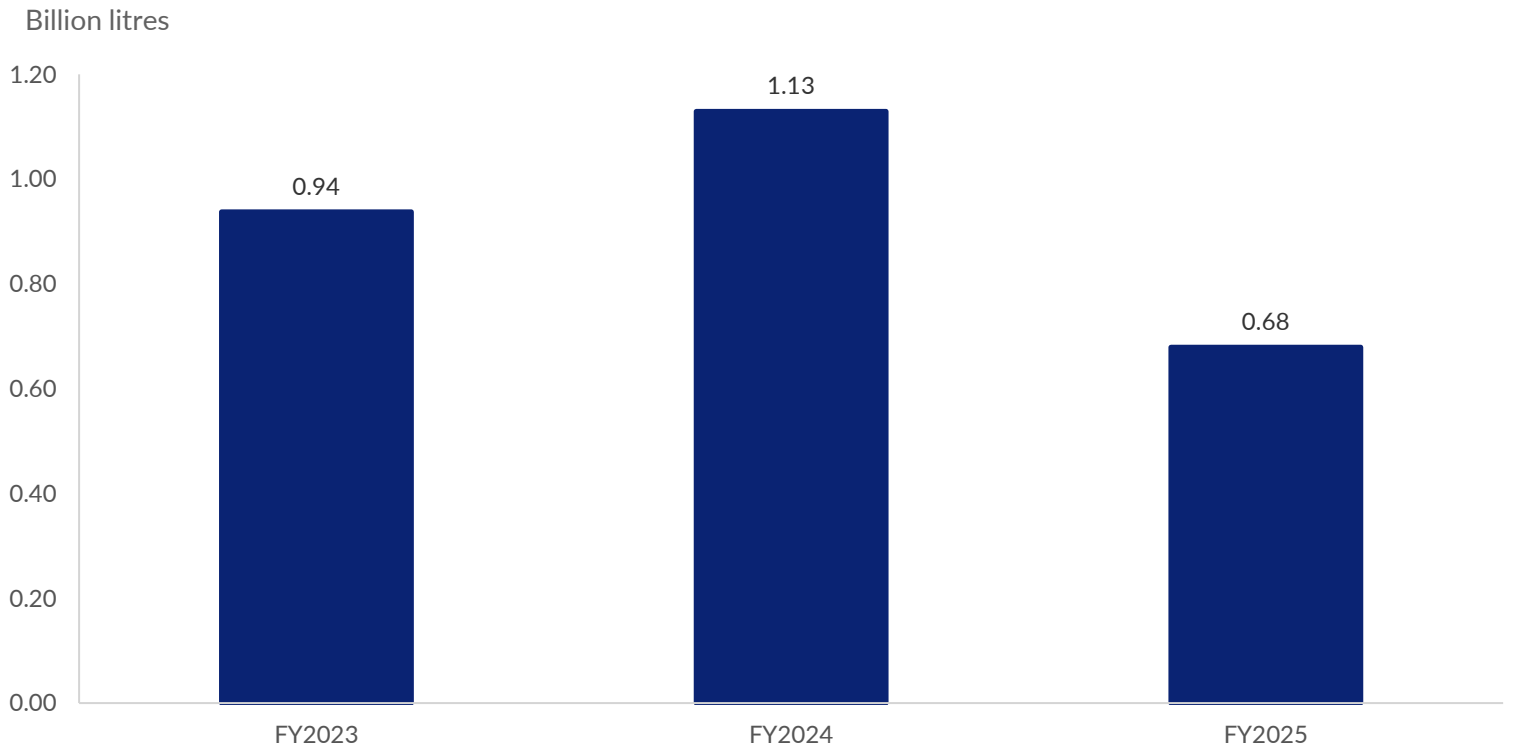
Demand component	Assumption / result	How it enters the estimate
Petrol activity	+0.5% per year in 2024–2025	More vehicle use supports consumption
Petrol fuel intensity	−1.5% per year in 2024–2025	A combined efficiency / fleet-mix assumption reduces fuel per unit of activity
Petrol demand	9.04bn L in 2023 → 8.86bn L in 2025	Compounding activity and intensity yields a modest decline
2030 road outlook	Base: 1% annual efficiency improvement	Applied after activity growth; rail displacement is then applied to freight only

The assumptions are explicit and editable; EV uptake is not counted again as a separate reduction.

Department 2023 sales; analytical workbook v02, Assumptions and Demand history. Activity and efficiency settings are authored planning assumptions.

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Eskom fuel use fell by about 40% in FY2025 as supply performance improved



Observed utility trend

FY2024: 1.130bn L

FY2025: 0.679bn L

The utility series includes kerosene. Fiscal years end in March.

The demand baseline replaces annual power consumption explicitly, so the decline is not hidden in a generic growth rate.

Eskom Integrated Report 2025 p141; staged source series. 679.1m L diesel + kerosene supersedes the earlier slide's 677.9m figure for this scope.

Further power recovery removes 0.54bn litres in the 2030 base case

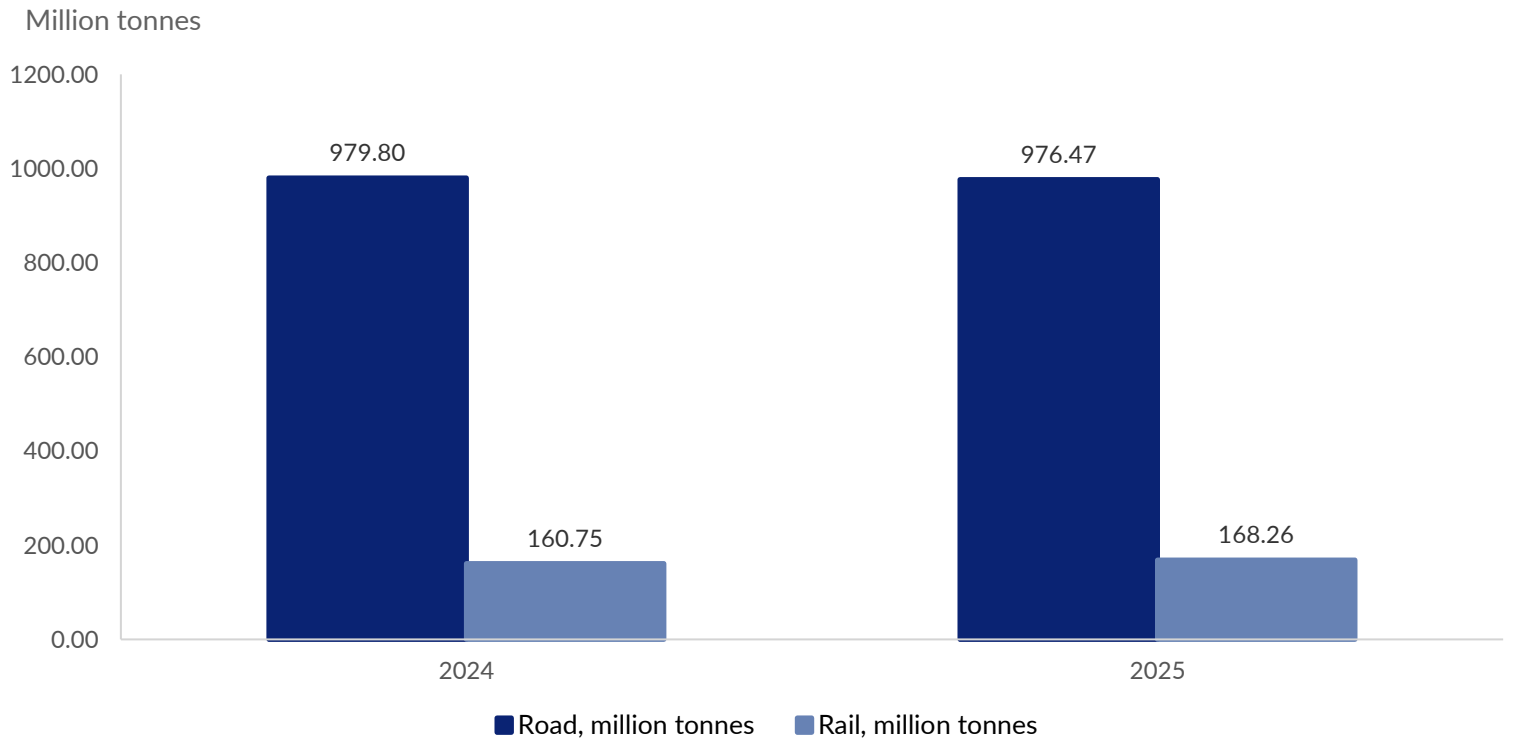
Power measure	Volume / assumption	Interpretation
2025 utility + private baseline	1.08bn litres	Eskom FY proxy, IPP generation conversion and private backup
Private backup within 2025 baseline	0.20bn litres assumed	Separate from reported Eskom fuel; not a measured national census
Base case to 2030	50% retained; 0.54bn L reduction	Recovery persists across utility and backup requirements
Sensitivity cases	0.00–0.70bn L reduction	High-import case retains power use; low-import case retains 35%

Power demand can fall without an equivalent decline in transport or industrial demand.

Analytical workbook v02, Segments / Driver bridge. Private backup 2023/24/25: 0.8/0.6/0.2bn L. IPP conversion: 0.31 L/kWh. FY-to-calendar and fuel-mix assumptions apply.

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Road still carries most reported freight despite the recent recovery in rail volumes



Reported freight

Road: 979.8 → 976.5m tonnes

Rail: 160.7 → 168.3m tonnes

Tonnes measure payload, not tonne-kilometres or directly displaced diesel.

Rail recovery changes fuel demand through eligible freight, distance, truck efficiency and the rail traction mix.

Stats SA P7162 December 2025 p7; all reported freight. Analytical workbook v02, Evidence.

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A 7.5% shift of road-freight activity to rail saves 0.33bn litres in the base case

2030 case	Road-freight shift	Net diesel reduction
Low imports	15.0%	0.62bn litres
Base	7.5%	0.33bn litres
High imports	2.5%	0.12bn litres
Calculation order	Activity → efficiency → modal shift	10% diesel rebound allowance for rail

These shifts apply to road-freight activity, not the entire diesel market; sector demand and power remain separate.

Analytical workbook v02, Driver bridge and scenario assumptions. Shift interpreted as freight tonne-km share. Distances and eligibility remain assumed; cases also vary growth and efficiency.

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The 5.8bn-litre production assumption leaves a gross import requirement of about 16.7bn litres

2025 national balance	bn litres	Basis
Demand	20.99	Estimated from the 2023 sales baseline
Domestic production	5.80	User-directed national planning assumption
Gross imports	16.70	SARS recorded customs litres
Exports	1.55	SARS recorded customs litres
Production + net imports	20.95	Availability before stock / statistical differences
Availability less demand	-0.03	Aggregate near-balance; product differences remain

5.8bn litres sets the planning case. Aggregate closure does not validate domestic output or its petrol/diesel split.

Analytical workbook v02, Balance and Supply assumption. User direction 11 October 2026. Original plant-based estimate 10.23bn L retained in appendix.

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Refinery recovery is the largest downside risk to the import requirement

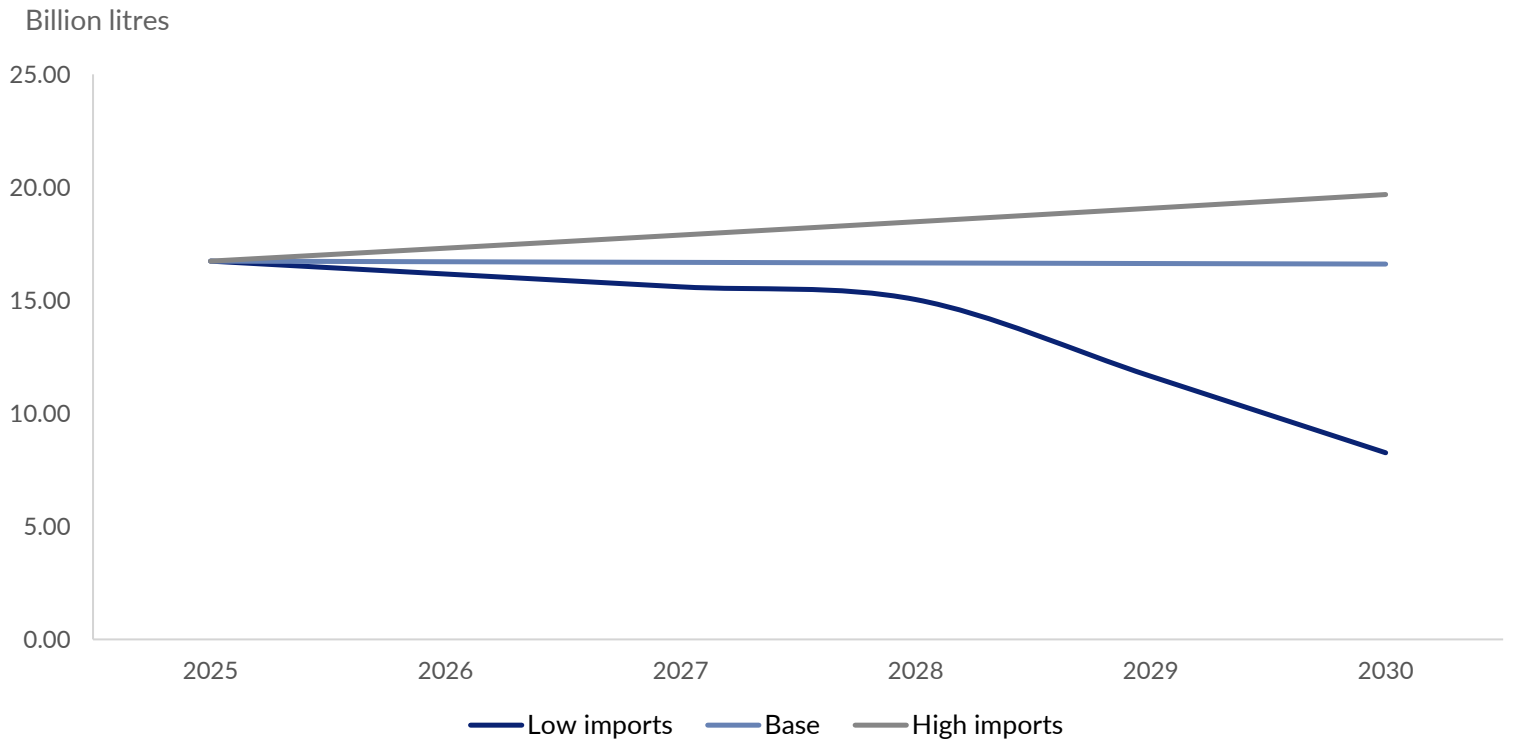
Supply lever	Base case	Low-import sensitivity
Operating domestic supply	5.8bn L through 2030	15% increase in the national planning volume
SAPREF	No refining restart through 2030	Assumed 2029 start; 65% utilisation after a two-year ramp
PetroSA / Mossel Bay	No refining restart through 2030	Assumed 2029 start; 50% utilisation after a two-year ramp
Combined restart contribution	Zero	5.67bn L petrol/diesel in 2030

Restart dates and ramp-up settings are scenario assumptions. Import-terminal operations can compete before refining resumes.

Registered scenario assumptions; DR08 refinery evidence. Capacity inputs: SAPREF 180kb/d, PetroSA 45kb/d; 70% petrol/diesel yield in restart sensitivities. Dates are not project commitments.

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Base-case imports remain near 16.6bn litres; refinery recovery creates a much lower outcome



2030 gross import need

Low imports: 8.26bn L

Base: 16.61bn L

High imports: 19.68bn L

Cases are sensitivities, not assigned probabilities.

The base case balances activity growth against efficiency, rail and power reductions; supply assumptions drive the widest spread.

Analytical workbook v02, Scenarios. Demand-implied gross imports = demand – domestic supply + 2025 exports. Zero stock change; 5.8bn L directed opening supply.

Matola provides an existing alternative gateway; new gas projects have a different role

Node	Evidence	Implication for South African fuel routes
Galp/IPG Matola	60,000m³ petrol/diesel storage; opened 2020	Existing import and distribution infrastructure
Petromoc Língamo / Matola	390,000m³ across liquid fuels	Broader storage base; product allocation and overlap need confirmation
Beira, Nacala and Pemba	Existing central / northern logistics nodes	Regional supply; no additional SA flow assigned in the base case
Temane PSA	Light oil, gas and LPG; production began December 2025	No direct finished petrol/diesel output credited
Komatipoort recorded imports	0.303bn L in 2022 → 0.086bn L in 2025	Current cross-border flow is far smaller than gross storage suggests

Storage capacity, berth capacity and delivered South African volumes measure different things and are not added together.

Galp Matola announcement (3 Dec 2020); Petromoc logistics; Sasol Mozambique operations; SARS customs. URLs retained in notes / workbook.

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Matola needs a landed-price or service advantage to offset border and logistics costs

Route sensitivity	Result	Assumptions behind the result
Durban → same inland destination	R0.95 per litre logistics	600km one way; round trip; R25/truck-km; 40,000L payload
Matola → same inland destination	R1.14 per litre logistics	550km one way; terminal and border costs; one-day delay
Matola premium	R0.19 per litre	Required landed-product discount under these illustrative costs
Border-delay sensitivity	R0.09–R0.40 per litre premium	Zero to three delay days
Base incremental Mozambique flow	0.20bn L by 2030	About 15 additional loaded trucks/day over 330 days

Mozambique diversion changes the gateway serving demand. It does not reduce South Africa's national import requirement.

Analytical workbook v02, Mozambique. Distances, tariffs, border charges, financing and allocation are authored sensitivities, not carrier quotes or confirmed access.

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Vopak's capture depends on the accessible share of Durban imports

Market / flow measure	Annual volume	Meaning for Vopak
National demand, 2025 estimate	20.99bn litres	Total consumption context
National gross imports, 2025	16.70bn litres	All recorded import gateways
Durban customs imports, 2025	13.16bn litres	Gateway proxy before customer and route allocation
Illustrative Durban capture	2.63bn litres	20% of Durban gateway volume; no contracted share inferred
Illustrative onward Lesedi flow	1.32bn litres	50% of captured Durban flow; counted within the same fuel volume

The illustrative unique flow is 2.63bn litres. Adding Lesedi would double-count fuel handled at both sites.

Registered market_review.yaml and market_review.json, 10 October. Capture is total conditional flow, not incremental sales; domestic and other-terminal Lesedi receipts are outside this screen.

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The illustrative capture case fits the tank-turn screen, making usable capacity the next test

Site	Illustrative flow bn L/year	Handling screen bn L/year	Operating basis
Durban	2.63	3.50	146,000m³ estimated working subset; two turns/month
Lesedi	1.32	2.98	124,000m³ working capacity, partly estimated; two turns/month
Investment test	Incremental contracts	Actual constraint	Receipt, product segregation, dispatch, pipeline access and peak demand

Working-tank arithmetic screens feasibility. Engineering limits and current customer flows determine actual headroom.

Registered terminal_site_assumptions.csv and market_review.json. Durban working subset is not the full terminal; access, peaks and current throughput remain open.

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The market supports an import platform; customer capture and capacity constraints govern investment

Conclusion	Evidence from this story	Decision implication
A substantial demand base	2025 estimated demand of 21.0bn litres	Prioritise identifiable customer segments and destinations
Base imports remain substantial	About 16.6bn litres in 2030 under the 5.8bn supply case	Plan for ongoing imports; retain refinery sensitivities
Gateways compete for the same fuel	Mozambique base diversion of 0.20bn L is a route assumption	Validate delivered cost, service and customer access
Expansion follows incremental capture	Illustrative 2.63bn L unique flow fits the tank-turn screen	Secure additional volumes, prove the bottleneck, then compare improvement and expansion returns

Next decisions: review the product balance, obtain route quotes and customer commitments, and establish usable capacity at both sites.

2025 analytical workbook v02: registered demand assumptions and user-directed 5.8bn L domestic production case. Estimates are not reported actuals.

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HG's South Africa storyline

SITUATION | The market and its drivers	COMPLICATION | Trends begin to reverse	RESOLUTION | Vopak's outlook
Outline South African demand development and Vopak's market of interest: eastern South Africa within economic reach of its storage infrastructure and NMPP. Explain the demand drivers: greater diesel use in power generation; rail to road; fuel prices; more efficient vehicles; and slow GDP growth. Outline the supply picture: refinery closures, challenges at Secunda and closure of Mossgas. Show growth in imports and where they enter.	A number of trends that supported demand growth have started to reverse: road to rail; the end of loadshedding and spare generation capacity; EVs/HEVs; and higher fuel prices affecting kilometres travelled. Explore supply changes: a SAPREF restart; Secunda's coal-derived gas, MRG sales and potential extension to 2032; and Natref's future. Compare Durban storage–NMPP–Lesedi with road/rail from Durban, transport from Matola and transport from Walvis Bay.	Market share of Vopak in Durban and Lesedi Potential scope for new investment?

Source: HG's supplied storyboard, slides 30–32 (6 October 2026). Condensed framing; propositions and questions to investigate. Pages 2-20 present the current analytical response.

The national supply assumption closes the total balance but leaves the product mix unresolved

2025 measure	Petrol bn L	Diesel bn L	Total bn L
2025 demand	8.86	12.13	20.99
Domestic production	3.20	2.60	5.80
Gross customs imports	4.45	12.25	16.70
Customs exports	0.80	0.75	1.55
Supply plus net imports	6.85	14.10	20.95
Unexplained availability less demand	-2.00	1.97	-0.03

The 5.8bn L override uses the original estimated production mix. Offsetting product differences remain visible; no product allocation is claimed as verified.

Analytical workbook v02, Supply assumption and Balance. Original plant estimate: Secunda 3.95, Natref 2.37, Astron 3.91bn L; 10.23bn total. These do not govern the directed case.

The conclusions are traceable to sources and a small set of explicit planning assumptions

Evidence / assumption	Used on pages	Basis / next validation
National sales and sector activity	3, 5–8	Department sales; energy balances; Stats SA. Manish: sales coverage and segment boundaries
Power and freight	4, 9–12	Eskom / IPP and Stats SA. Nigel: backup demand, eligible rail shift and efficiency
Domestic supply and imports	13–15, 22	5.8bn L user-directed supply; SARS trade. Manish: product-level reconciliation
Mozambique infrastructure and costs	16–17	Operator disclosures; authored cost sensitivities. Nigel: comparable quotes and access
Vopak capture and handling	18–20	Registered illustrative capture and working tanks. Vopak/Nigel: contracts and operating limits

Planning assumptions remain editable in workbook v02. Source observations, estimates and sensitivities retain separate labels.

Source register: REG-SA-ANALYTICS-202510 and REG-SA-STORY-CASE-2025. Exception EXC-SA-ANALYTICS-202510; review before external use, expiry 12 November 2026.

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